

ETH-01 · CODE OF ETHICS

The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct

The conduct instrument binding every PCI candidate and certificant

VERSION 1.0 · DRAFT
2026-08-04

PROJECT CONTROLS INSTITUTE GLOBAL, INC.
AI proposes. The professional disposes.

— Summary

The Institute's code of ethics and professional conduct: the standard of behaviour required of everyone who applies for, sits for or holds a PCI credential. It states eight principles and then gives them operative effect in numbered obligations covering the reporting of numbers, competence, confidentiality, conflicts of interest, commercial dealing, artificial intelligence and data, conduct towards the Institute and its examinations, the raising of concerns, and what happens when the Code is breached. It is a professional instrument, not a statement of law, and clauses are numbered so that any one of them can be cited exactly in a decision.

— About this document

Document	ETH-01
Series	Code of Ethics
Version	1.0
Status	draft
Date	2026-08-04
Unresolved placeholders	9

Notice. This document is an educational publication of Project Controls Institute Global, Inc., and does not constitute accounting, tax, legal, financial or other professional advice. It must not be relied upon as such. Where a topic depends on the contract or the governing law, entitlement and treatment vary by jurisdiction; take local advice.

Standards. Standards and frameworks are referred to by name and described in this publication's own words. No standard's text, tables, diagrams or question banks are reproduced. All trademarks remain the property of their respective owners, and no endorsement by any standards body, employer or vendor is implied or should be inferred.

Status. Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. is a Delaware Non-Stock Corporation. The Institute has been developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by ANAB, IAS or any other accreditation body. It intends to seek 501(c)(3) recognition, which has not been granted. No governmental approval, academic equivalence, or guaranteed employment, promotion or salary outcome is claimed or implied.

Examples. All worked examples are illustrative and fictional. Figures are chosen to demonstrate a method, not to describe any real project, organisation or market. Sample examination items, where they appear, are study material maintained separately from any live examination bank.

Completeness. Passages marked **[CONFIRM: ...]** are operational or market facts that have not yet been confirmed from a cited source. A document carrying them is a working draft and is not approved for publication.

© 2026 Project Controls Institute Global, Inc. · All rights reserved.

Contents

1. Status and authority	6
1.1 What this Code is	6
1.2 Why the Institute maintains a code	6
1.3 Effect	6
1.4 What this Code is not	6
1.5 Commencement and supersession	7
1.6 Precedence	7
1.7 Founding-stage status	7
2. Scope — who is bound, and when	7
2.1 Persons bound	7
2.2 Membership grades	8
2.3 Conduct covered	8
2.4 Territorial application	8
2.5 Obligations that survive	8
3. Interpretation	9
3.1 Definitions	9
3.2 Reading conventions	9
3.3 Relationship to law	9
3.4 Relationship to employer policy	10
4. The principles	10
4.0 How the principles work	10
4.1 Integrity of the numbers	10
4.2 Competence and its limits	10
4.3 Confidentiality	10
4.4 Conflicts of interest	10
4.5 Fair dealing in commercial matters	10
4.6 Refusal to misstate	11
4.7 Duties to the profession and the Institute	11
4.8 Governed use of AI	11
5. Obligations in preparing and reporting numbers	11
5.1 Truthfulness	11
5.2 Assumptions, basis and limits	11
5.3 Selective truth	11
5.4 Cut-off, accrual and period discipline	12
5.5 Progress, quantities and rules of credit	12
5.6 Schedule integrity	12
5.7 Correction of error	12
5.8 Records	12
5.9 Refusal and escalation	13

6. Obligations to those who rely on the work	13
6.1 Who relies	13
6.2 Information bearing on safety, the environment and the public	13
6.3 Where interests conflict	13
6.4 The limit of the obligation	13
7. Obligations to the employer or client	14
7.1 Diligent service	14
7.2 Advocacy and its boundary	14
7.3 Instructions	14
7.4 After leaving	14
8. Competence and currency	14
8.1 Working within competence	14
8.2 Declaring the limit	14
8.3 Currency	15
8.4 Supervision	15
8.5 Representing qualifications	15
9. Confidentiality and information handling	15
9.1 What is protected	15
9.2 Purpose limitation	15
9.3 Disclosure	15
9.4 Personal data	15
9.5 Tools and transmission	15
9.6 Survival	16
9.7 Personal advantage	16
10. Data and artificial intelligence	16
10.1 The rule	16
10.2 Verification	16
10.3 The duty to explain	16
10.4 Transparency	16
10.5 Confidential data in AI tools	16
10.6 Accountability is not delegable	17
10.7 Record	17
11. Conduct in relation to the Institute and its examinations	17
11.1 Honesty in dealings	17
11.2 Conduct in examination	17
11.3 Examination content	17
11.4 Cooperation and reporting	18
11.5 Use of the designation	18
12. Conflicts of interest	18
12.1 The standard	18
12.2 Disclosure	18
12.3 Safeguards and withdrawal	18
12.4 Self-review	19

12.5 Inducements.....	19
13. Raising concerns	19
13.1 Route.....	19
13.2 To the Institute	19
13.3 Good faith	19
13.4 What the Institute can and cannot do	19
14. Breach and consequences.....	20
14.1 What is a breach	20
14.2 Assessing seriousness.....	20
14.3 Fair process	20
14.4 Range of outcomes	20
14.5 Appeal	20
14.6 What is not a defence	20
15. Review, amendment and language	21
15.1 Review	21
15.2 Amendment	21
15.3 Transitional rule.....	21
15.4 Language	21
Related	21
Sources and standards.....	21
Status and version	22

The PCI code of ethics and professional conduct

In one paragraph. This is the Institute's code of ethics and professional conduct: the standard of behaviour required of everyone who applies for, sits for or holds a PCI credential. It states eight principles and then gives them operative effect in numbered obligations covering the reporting of numbers, competence, confidentiality, conflicts of interest, commercial dealing, artificial intelligence and data, conduct towards the Institute and its examinations, the raising of concerns, and what happens when the Code is breached. It is a professional instrument, not a statement of law: legal duties and protections differ between countries, sectors and employment arrangements, and nothing here replaces qualified local advice. Clauses are numbered so that a manager, an investigator or a certificant can point at one exactly — ETH-01 §5.7 — in a conversation, a report or a decision.

Who this is for. Candidates for and holders of PCI credentials; the managers, sponsors, auditors and employers who rely on their work; and anyone conducting or answering a conduct case under PCI governance.

— 1. Status and authority

1.1 What this Code is

This Code states the conduct the Institute requires of the people it certifies. It is the senior conduct instrument of the Project Controls Institute: where another Institute policy addresses the same behaviour in more detail, that policy governs the detail and this Code governs the principle.

1.2 Why the Institute maintains a code

Project controls is a discipline of trusted numbers. A forecast, a variance analysis, a progress valuation or a risk register is only useful to the person relying on it if they can assume it was prepared honestly, competently and without a hidden agenda. Everything a controls professional produces is an input to somebody else's decision — to fund, to stop, to pay, to escalate, to reassure a board. This Code exists so that a PCI credential carries that assumption for every holder, everywhere.

1.3 Effect

Acceptance of this Code is a condition of applying for, sitting for, holding and renewing a PCI credential. A person bound by it is answerable to the Institute for compliance with it, and the Institute's response to a breach operates on the person's standing with the Institute — see §14.

1.4 What this Code is not

1.4.1 It is not law, and it does not describe, create, extend or replace any legal right, duty, defence or protection.

1.4.2 It is not legal advice, and the Institute does not give legal advice to candidates or certificants.

1.4.3 It is not a contract of employment, and it does not override a lawful and proper instruction from an employer except in the specific respects stated in §7.3.

1.4.4 It does not give a third party any right to enforce it. The Institute enforces it, through decisions about certification and candidature and nothing else.

1.5 Commencement and supersession

1.5.1 This Code supersedes and expands the Institute's earlier Code of Professional Conduct, which was issued under a credential code that has since been retired. The eight principles of that document are carried forward without change of substance; this Code adds scope, definitions, operative obligations, the treatment of artificial intelligence and data, and the consequences of breach.

1.5.2 Commencement: [CONFIRM: commencement date for this Code, and the date on which the predecessor Code of Professional Conduct is withdrawn from the Downloads Centre].

1.5.3 Conduct is judged under the version of the Code in force at the time of the conduct — see §15.3.

1.6 Precedence

Where this Code, an Institute policy and an employer's policy all speak to the same behaviour, they are read in this order:

Rank	Instrument	What it governs
1	Applicable law of the place where the person works	Everything. Where the law requires something this Code does not, the law governs.
2	This Code	The professional standard required by the Institute
3	The Institute's specific policies — examination rules, appeals, complaints, privacy, AI standard	The operational detail within the principle
4	The employer's or client's own policies	Everything not inconsistent with the above

A stricter employer policy is followed. A more permissive employer policy does not lower the standard in this Code.

1.7 Founding-stage status

The Institute is at founding stage and says so. PCI is developed with reference to ISO/IEC 17024 personnel-certification principles and is **not accredited** by any accreditation body. This Code describes obligations the Institute imposes and enforces itself; it should not be read as implying external recognition, endorsement or statutory standing of any kind.

2. Scope — who is bound, and when

2.1 Persons bound

This Code binds:

- 2.1.1 every applicant for a PCI credential, from the moment an application is submitted;
- 2.1.2 every candidate — a person holding a live examination authorisation, whether or not the examination has been sat;
- 2.1.3 every certificant — a holder of a current PCI credential (PCL-AI, PFL-AI or PML-AI) or of the AI in Project Controls — Specialist Certificate;
- 2.1.4 every former certificant, in respect of conduct that occurred while they were bound, and in respect of the continuing obligations at §2.5;
- 2.1.5 every person who has been awarded a credential by a route that does not require an examination, on the same terms as any other certificant.

2.2 Membership grades

Membership of the Institute and certification by the Institute are different ladders and are not conflated here. A member who also holds a PCI credential is bound by this Code as a certificant. Whether a member who holds no PCI certification is bound is not yet settled: [CONFIRM: whether this Code binds PCI members who hold no PCI certification, and if so from which membership grade].

2.3 Conduct covered

- 2.3.1 This Code applies to conduct in professional life: work performed, advice given, records made, representations made, and dealings with employers, clients, colleagues and the Institute.
- 2.3.2 It applies to conduct outside professional life only where that conduct bears directly on the trust reasonably placed in a holder of the credential — for example, dishonesty in a matter of personal finance that a reasonable employer would regard as relevant to entrusting the person with cost data.
- 2.3.3 It does not give the Institute a general licence to police private life, and a conduct case is not opened on that basis.

2.4 Territorial application

This Code applies wherever the person works. It is written to be jurisdiction-neutral: it states professional obligations, not the law of any country. Where a professional obligation in this Code and the law of the place where a person works appear to conflict, §3.3 governs.

2.5 Obligations that survive

The following continue after an engagement, an employment or a certification ends:

- confidentiality of information obtained in the course of the work (§9);
- confidentiality of examination content (§11.3);
- honesty about certification status held, formerly held or never held (§8.5, §11.8);
- cooperation with an Institute investigation into conduct that occurred while bound (§11.5), for so long as the person seeks to hold, restore or reapply for a credential.

— 3. Interpretation

3.1 Definitions

Term	Meaning in this Code
the Institute	Project Controls Institute Global, Inc.
certificant	A holder of a current PCI credential or certificate
candidate	An applicant or a person holding a live examination authorisation
the work	Any professional output: estimate, forecast, schedule, valuation, variance analysis, risk assessment, claim, report, dashboard, model or advice
a number	Any quantified statement in the work — a cost, a date, a percentage, a probability, a quantity, a rating
materially misleading	Capable of changing the decision of a reasonable person relying on it, whether by what it states, what it omits, or how it is framed
AI tool	Any software system that generates, transforms, ranks, predicts or summarises content or values in a way that substitutes for or supplements human analytical judgement
conflict of interest	An interest that could reasonably be seen to influence the person's professional judgement, whether or not it in fact does
detriment	Adverse treatment because a person raised a concern — dismissal, demotion, exclusion, withdrawal of work, or informal disadvantage

3.2 Reading conventions

3.2.1 **Must** states an obligation; failure is a breach. **Should** states expected practice; departure requires a reason the person can articulate and, where the matter is material, record.

3.2.2 **Reasonable** is judged by what a competent practitioner in the same role, with the same information and the same time, would have done — not by hindsight and not by the ideal case.

3.2.3 Headings and the summary paragraph do not limit the clauses.

3.3 Relationship to law

3.3.1 Employment law, whistleblowing protection, data-protection law, anti-bribery and anti-corruption law, securities law, competition law, company law and professional-liability law differ substantially between jurisdictions — and within a jurisdiction they differ between sectors, between employment and contracting arrangements, and over time. **This Code does not state any of them.**

3.3.2 Nothing in this Code should be read as an assurance that a course of action it requires, permits or encourages is lawful, protected or free of consequence in a particular place. In some jurisdictions a disclosure of wrongdoing attracts statutory protection subject to conditions; in others the protection is narrow, conditional or absent.

3.3.3 Where the law requires something this Code does not, the law governs. Where a person believes that complying with this Code would require them to break the law, they must say so to the Institute rather than resolve it silently, and the Institute will consider the conflict on its facts.

3.3.4 Before making a disclosure outside their own organisation, before resigning over an ethical matter, and before signing anything they believe to be false, a person **should** take advice from a qualified adviser in their own jurisdiction. The Institute cannot provide that advice and does not underwrite the consequences of a disclosure.

3.4 Relationship to employer policy

Compliance with an employer's policy is not a defence to a breach of this Code, and compliance with this Code is not a defence to a breach of an employer's lawful policy. Where the two genuinely cannot both be satisfied, the person must raise it — internally first, then with the Institute — and record having done so.

— 4. The principles

4.0 How the principles work

Eight principles are stated below. They restate, in the same order and to the same effect, the principles of the predecessor Code of Professional Conduct; the numbering has changed, the substance has not. Each is given operative effect in the numbered obligations at §§5–13. A conduct case cites both — the principle and the obligation.

4.1 Integrity of the numbers

The certificant reports what the evidence shows. Forecasts, variances, progress and risk are stated truthfully, with their assumptions and limits disclosed, whether or not the answer is welcome.

4.2 Competence and its limits

The certificant works within their competence, keeps that competence current, and says so plainly when a task requires expertise they do not have.

4.3 Confidentiality

Cost data, commercial positions, performance information and personal data are protected, used only for the purpose for which they were entrusted, and never traded for personal advantage.

4.4 Conflicts of interest

The certificant's professional judgement is not for sale and not for rent. Actual, potential and perceived conflicts are disclosed before they can colour a conclusion.

4.5 Fair dealing in commercial matters

In valuations, applications for payment, claims, variations and negotiations, the certificant deals honestly. Advocacy for an employer or client is legitimate; misrepresentation is not.

4.6 Refusal to misstate

Being instructed to present a false or misleading number does not excuse presenting it. The duty is escalation, not participation.

4.7 Duties to the profession and the Institute

The value of a PCI credential depends on the integrity of the process that awards it and the honesty of those who hold it. Every candidate and certificant shares in protecting both.

4.8 Governed use of AI

Using AI well is part of professional competence; governing it is part of professional conduct. AI proposes; the professional disposes. Accountability for an output carrying the certificant's name cannot be delegated to software.

— 5. Obligations in preparing and reporting numbers

Gives effect to §4.1, §4.5 and §4.6.

5.1 Truthfulness

5.1.1 A certificant must not state, sign, issue or knowingly transmit a number they believe to be materially false or misleading.

5.1.2 A certificant must not manufacture, suppress, reclassify or reallocate a variance, a cost, a quantity, a date or a risk in order to disguise the position of a project.

5.1.3 A forecast must reflect performance to date and honest assumptions about the remainder. A number selected because it is acceptable, and justified afterwards, breaches §4.1 even if it later turns out to be right.

5.2 Assumptions, basis and limits

5.2.1 Every estimate, forecast and quantitative analysis must carry its assumptions, its basis and its exclusions in a form the recipient will actually see — not only in an appendix that the summary contradicts.

5.2.2 The certificant must state plainly what the analysis cannot support. A single-point forecast presented without its uncertainty, where uncertainty is material, is misleading by omission.

5.2.3 Where a result depends on an assumption that a reasonable recipient would question, the assumption is named in the same breath as the result.

5.3 Selective truth

A statement that is literally accurate may still be materially misleading through selection, framing, aggregation or omission — a favourable subset presented as the whole, a metric shown at the level where it looks best, an adverse trend excluded because it is "not yet confirmed". §5.1 applies to the impression created, not only to the individual figures.

5.4 Cut-off, accrual and period discipline

5.4.1 Cost incurred in a period must be reported in that period, in accordance with the accounting framework and cut-off policy applying to the entity. Recognition frameworks differ between jurisdictions and entities; the obligation here is to apply the applicable one consistently, not to apply any particular one.

5.4.2 Deferring the recognition of a known cost, accelerating the recognition of revenue or progress, or moving a transaction across a period boundary **in order to improve a reported metric**, is a breach of §4.1 regardless of whether the movement is later reversed.

5.4.3 Where a genuine judgement about timing exists, the judgement, its grounds and its effect on the headline metrics are disclosed to the person relying on the report.

5.5 Progress, quantities and rules of credit

5.5.1 Progress is measured by the rule of credit that applies to the work package, applied consistently, and evidenced.

5.5.2 A certificant must not adopt a more generous measurement basis for a period because the period is a reporting boundary, nor apply a rule of credit selectively across packages to produce a target percentage.

5.5.3 Where measured progress and claimed progress differ, the difference is reported, not netted away.

5.6 Schedule integrity

5.6.1 A schedule must represent the plan as it is genuinely intended to be executed, with logic, durations and constraints that a competent reviewer could reconstruct.

5.6.2 A certificant must not conceal or absorb float, apply artificial constraints, break logic, or manipulate calendars or durations in order to make a forecast completion date agree with a required date.

5.6.3 Where the honest calculated completion is later than the required completion, that fact is reported. Mitigation is proposed as mitigation — with its cost, its risk and its owner — not presented as though it had already happened.

5.7 Correction of error

5.7.1 An error discovered in issued work must be corrected promptly and openly, to everyone who received the original and to anyone the certificant knows to be relying on it.

5.7.2 The correction states what was wrong, what the corrected position is, and what decisions may have been affected. Quietly reissuing a corrected file is not a correction.

5.7.3 A certificant must not allow a number they know to be wrong to stand because correcting it is inconvenient, embarrassing or commercially awkward.

5.8 Records

A certificant must keep, for the work they own, a record sufficient for a competent reviewer to reconstruct how a number was produced: the source data, the method, the assumptions, the adjust-

ments made and by whom, and the review or approval applied. Where an instruction changed a reported number, the instruction and its author form part of that record.

5.9 Refusal and escalation

5.9.1 A certificant instructed to prepare, sign or transmit something they believe to be materially misleading must decline.

5.9.2 They must raise the concern through the proper channels of their own organisation — line management, project governance, internal audit, an ethics or compliance route — and keep a factual record of having done so, including dates, recipients and what was said.

5.9.3 Where the concern is not resolved, they must escalate rather than acquiesce by silence, taking advice where the situation warrants it (§3.3.4).

5.9.4 Pressure from an employer, client, manager or sponsor is not accepted by the Institute as a defence to participation in a misstatement. Neither is the fact that the number was ultimately issued by somebody else, where the certificant supplied it knowing how it would be used.

— 6. Obligations to those who rely on the work

6.1 Who relies

The people who rely on project controls output are rarely in the room: an investment committee, a lender, a board, a public body, an insurer, a joint-venture partner, a workforce whose jobs depend on a project's viability. The obligation in §5 exists because of them.

6.2 Information bearing on safety, the environment and the public

6.2.1 A certificant must not suppress, dilute or delay information in their control that bears on the safety of persons, on environmental harm, or on a matter of clear public interest, and must raise it through the appropriate route without waiting to be asked.

6.2.2 Where cost or schedule pressure is being resolved by reducing a control that exists for safety or compliance reasons, the certificant must record and report that as the trade-off it is, rather than as an efficiency.

6.3 Where interests conflict

Where the interest of an employer or client conflicts with the accuracy of information that others will rely on for a significant decision, accuracy prevails. This does not license unilateral external disclosure: it requires the escalation and record in §5.9, and, where the person is considering going outside the organisation, the advice in §3.3.4.

6.4 The limit of the obligation

A certificant is obliged to report honestly, escalate properly and record what they did. They are not obliged to guarantee an outcome they do not control, and the Institute does not treat a person as being in breach because a properly escalated concern was overruled by people with the authority to overrule it.

— 7. Obligations to the employer or client

7.1 Diligent service

A certificant serves their employer or client competently, diligently and in good faith, uses resources for their intended purpose, and does not misuse position, systems or information for personal benefit.

7.2 Advocacy and its boundary

Presenting an employer's or client's position in its strongest honest form is legitimate. The boundary is misrepresentation: asserting as fact what is not established, relying on records the certificant knows to be inaccurate, or allowing a material misstatement made on the employer's behalf to stand uncorrected once the certificant knows of it.

7.3 Instructions

7.3.1 Lawful and proper instructions are followed.

7.3.2 An instruction to produce, alter or withhold a number so as to create a materially misleading impression is not a proper instruction, and §5.9 applies.

7.3.3 An instruction to change a number that comes with a genuine reason — new information, a corrected assumption, a different and defensible method — is not improper merely because it is unwelcome. The distinction is whether the change is supported by evidence and would survive disclosure to the person relying on the report.

7.4 After leaving

Confidentiality survives the engagement (§9.6). A certificant must not take, retain or use an employer's or client's confidential material after leaving, and must not use knowledge of a former employer's confidential commercial position to that employer's disadvantage in a subsequent role — see [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) for how this is managed in practice.

— 8. Competence and currency

8.1 Working within competence

A certificant undertakes only work they are competent to perform, or work performed under supervision by someone who is, and says so before the work starts rather than after it fails.

8.2 Declaring the limit

Where a task requires expertise the certificant does not hold — a specialist contractual analysis, a statistical method, a taxation or accounting treatment, a modelling technique — they must say so and obtain the expertise, rather than produce an approximation and present it as an analysis.

8.3 Currency

8.3.1 A certificant must maintain their knowledge and skill across the discipline as methods, standards and tools evolve, including the governed use of AI.

8.3.2 Recertification runs on a three-year cycle and includes a mandatory AI-currency component. The binding continuing-professional-development requirement will be published with the recertification rules; the figure shown as a target in the student portal is a target and not a rule, and this Code does not state a required number of hours.

8.4 Supervision

A certificant who supervises others is responsible for the review they said they performed. Signing or approving work implies that the reviewer applied judgement to it — not that they received it.

8.5 Representing qualifications

A certificant must not claim or imply qualifications, experience, employment history or certification status they do not hold, and must correct such a claim promptly if it is made on their behalf.

— 9. Confidentiality and information handling

9.1 What is protected

Cost and rate data, estimates, commercial positions, bid and tender information, contract terms, claims strategy, performance and productivity data, security-relevant design information, personal data, and anything the owner has marked or treats as confidential.

9.2 Purpose limitation

Confidential information is used only for the purpose for which it was entrusted. Using it for a different purpose — a benchmark, a bid, an article, a job application, a study exercise, a demonstration — requires the owner's authority.

9.3 Disclosure

Confidential information is disclosed only with proper authority, or where disclosure is required by law or by a competent authority. Where a certificant believes disclosure is required by law, §3.3.4 applies before they act.

9.4 Personal data

Personal data encountered in the work — payroll, timesheets, competence records, proctoring material, health information supporting an adjustment — is handled on a need-to-know basis and in accordance with the applicable data-protection framework, which differs by jurisdiction.

9.5 Tools and transmission

A certificant must take reasonable care with the tools and channels they use so that confidential information is not exposed to systems outside the owner's control. This includes personal devices,

personal accounts, file-sharing services and AI tools — see §10.5 and [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#).

9.6 Survival

Confidentiality obligations continue after the engagement, the employment and the certification end. There is no point at which commercially sensitive information becomes fair use because time has passed, unless the owner has released it or it has genuinely become public other than through a breach.

9.7 Personal advantage

A certificant must not use confidential information for personal advantage, or enable another person to do so. Dealing in securities, bidding, or arranging a personal or family interest on the strength of non-public project information breaches §4.3 — and may in addition be unlawful, on terms that vary greatly between jurisdictions.

— 10. Data and artificial intelligence

Full treatment is in [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#). The binding obligations are here.

10.1 The rule

AI proposes; the professional disposes. An AI tool may draft a forecast, flag an anomaly, classify a risk or write a narrative. It cannot be accountable for the result. The named human is.

10.2 Verification

A certificant must verify an AI-assisted output against independent evidence — a conventional method, a benchmark, a prior period, their own reasoning — before relying on it, matching the depth of the check to the consequence of being wrong.

10.3 The duty to explain

A certificant must be able to explain, in their own words and without the tool in front of them, what data a submitted number rests on, how it was produced and why it holds. "The model said so" is never a defence, and inability to explain a number you submitted is itself a breach of §4.8.

10.4 Transparency

Where AI's contribution to a conclusion is material, the certificant makes that visible to reviewers and recipients, so that what was machine-proposed can be distinguished from what was human-judged.

10.5 Confidential data in AI tools

A certificant must not enter confidential project, commercial or personal data into an AI tool outside the data owner's control and policies. Anonymisation is not a licence: where the residual detail would still identify the project, the party or the person, the data remains confidential.

10.6 Accountability is not delegable

Output carrying a certificant's name is theirs, whatever produced it. Neither the vendor's terms nor the tool's limitations transfer that accountability.

10.7 Record

Where AI materially contributed to a submitted output, the certificant keeps a short record: the tool, the inputs supplied, the check performed, and the named owner of the result. This is what makes AI-assisted work defensible months later.

— 11. Conduct in relation to the Institute and its examinations

11.1 Honesty in dealings

Every statement made to the Institute — in an application, an eligibility declaration, an accommodation request, a CPD claim, an appeal or an investigation — must be true and complete, and supporting evidence must be genuine.

11.2 Conduct in examination

A candidate must:

11.2.1 present genuine identification and sit the examination personally — impersonation in either direction is among the most serious breaches of this Code;

11.2.2 use no unauthorised material, device, resource or assistance of any kind;

11.2.3 use no AI assistance of any kind during a sitting — including AI assistants, AI-enabled search, AI features embedded in other software, and any tool that generates, retrieves or transforms answer content — however obtained, on the examination device, on a second device, or through another person;

11.2.4 comply with the invigilation and proctoring arrangements published for the sitting, including identity verification, the environment check and restrictions on additional displays;

11.2.5 follow the proctor's instructions throughout, and report a disruption at the time rather than after the result is known;

11.2.6 know the rules published for their own sitting, which set out the full list of permitted and prohibited materials.

The prohibition on AI in the examination does not rest on detection. It rests on the meaning of the credential: a pass obtained with a tool's help would certify the tool.

11.3 Examination content

11.3.1 Examination items are confidential. A candidate or certificant must not disclose, reconstruct, record, share, sell, publish or solicit live examination content, before or after a sitting, however informal the setting.

11.3.2 This obligation is permanent and survives the loss or surrender of a credential.

11.3.3 Preparing others using reconstructed items, or knowingly using reconstructed items to prepare, breaches §4.7 whether or not money changes hands.

11.4 Cooperation and reporting

11.4.1 A candidate or certificant must cooperate openly and truthfully with an Institute investigation, and must not destroy, alter or withhold relevant records.

11.4.2 A candidate or certificant must report to the Institute credible evidence of certification fraud, impersonation or examination misconduct by another person.

11.4.3 Self-reporting: [CONFIRM: whether a certificant must notify PCI of a criminal conviction, regulatory finding or dismissal for dishonesty, and within what period].

11.5 Use of the designation

11.5.1 The designation is used only while the person is entitled to it, in the form the Institute publishes, and is discontinued immediately on expiry, suspension or withdrawal.

11.5.2 A certificant must not describe the credential as accredited, government-recognised, equivalent to a degree, or as guaranteeing employment, and must not attribute to it recognition it does not carry. The Institute holds itself to the same standard.

11.5.3 A certificant must not present a membership grade as a certification, or a certification as a membership grade.

— 12. Conflicts of interest

Full treatment is in [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#).

12.1 The standard

A conflict exists where an interest could reasonably be seen to influence professional judgement. The test is what a reasonable, informed observer would think — not whether the certificant believes themselves to be objective.

12.2 Disclosure

12.2.1 A certificant must disclose an actual, potential or perceived conflict promptly, in writing where the matter is material, to the person or body able to act on it, and before the judgement in question is exercised.

12.2.2 A disclosure states the interest, its size or closeness, the decisions it touches, and what the certificant proposes should happen.

12.3 Safeguards and withdrawal

Where a conflict can be managed — by reallocation, independent review, exclusion from a decision, or an information barrier — the safeguard is recorded and applied. Where it cannot be managed, the certificant declines the work or withdraws from it.

12.4 Self-review

A certificant must not provide independent assurance over their own work, or over work they directed. Preparing an estimate and then auditing the same estimate is not independence, however capable the individual.

12.5 Inducements

A certificant must not accept or offer any inducement intended to influence a professional conclusion, a valuation, a certification, an award or a decision. Gifts and hospitality are governed by the applicable employer policy and by law, both of which vary; the obligation in this Code is that nothing is accepted or offered which the certificant would be unwilling to disclose to the person relying on their judgement.

— 13. Raising concerns

Full treatment is in [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#).

13.1 Route

A concern about conduct is ordinarily raised first within the organisation where it arises, through line management, project governance, audit, or an ethics or compliance route, and recorded.

13.2 To the Institute

A concern about the conduct of a PCI candidate or certificant may be raised with the Institute by anyone, including a person outside the Institute: [\[CONFIRM: the published address and web route for raising a conduct concern with PCI\]](#).

13.3 Good faith

A person who raises a concern honestly and on reasonable grounds is not in breach of this Code because the concern is not upheld. Raising a concern known to be false, or raising one to harass or gain advantage, is itself a breach.

13.4 What the Institute can and cannot do

13.4.1 The Institute will not treat a person adversely in their standing with the Institute because they raised a concern in good faith.

13.4.2 The Institute cannot protect a person from an employer's response, cannot compel an employer to act, and cannot confer any legal protection. Whether an external disclosure attracts legal protection depends entirely on local law and the circumstances — §3.3 applies, and advice should be taken before acting.

— 14. Breach and consequences

14.1 What is a breach

A failure to meet an obligation stated as a **must** in §§5–13, or conduct inconsistent with a principle in §4 that is serious enough to bear on the trust placed in the credential.

14.2 Assessing seriousness

The factors considered include: whether the conduct was deliberate, reckless or careless; the materiality of the effect and who was exposed to it; whether it was concealed; whether it was repeated; the person's seniority and the reliance placed on them; whether they self-reported and corrected; whether they cooperated; the pressure they were under, which may mitigate but does not excuse; and any previous finding.

14.3 Fair process

A person facing a conduct case is told what is alleged and on what evidence, is given a genuine opportunity to respond, and is judged by people with no conflict of interest in the matter. The decision is recorded with reasons.

14.3.1 [CONFIRM: which PCI body determines conduct cases at first instance, and its relationship to the Certification & Impartiality Committee].

14.3.2 [CONFIRM: whether PCI may impose an interim suspension of a credential while an investigation is in progress, on whose authority, and on what test].

14.4 Range of outcomes

Outcomes are proportionate to the breach and range from guidance and a recorded warning, through conditions on continued certification, to suspension and — in serious cases — withdrawal of certification. Where the conduct concerns an examination, an outcome may also include invalidation of a result and loss of the right to resit.

14.4.1 The Institute does not publish a fixed tariff of sanctions in this Code, and none should be inferred: [CONFIRM: the published sanction range and any tariff, including the minimum period before a person whose certification has been withdrawn may reapply].

14.4.2

[CONFIRM: whether conduct outcomes are published, in what form, with or without identification, and for how long].

14.5 Appeal

An adverse decision carries a right of appeal, heard by people independent of the original decision. The routes, the grounds and the time limits are in [ETH-06](#) and in the Institute's published appeals policy; this Code states no timescale, because none should be invented.

14.6 What is not a defence

Instruction from a manager, client or employer; commercial pressure; local custom; the fact that others do the same; the absence of a specific prohibition in an employer's policy; ignorance of this Code; or the fact that the misstatement was never acted upon.

— 15. Review, amendment and language

15.1 Review

This Code is reviewed under PCI governance: [\[CONFIRM: the review cycle for this Code and the body that approves amendments\]](#).

15.2 Amendment

Amendments are versioned. A change that alters what a person must do is a major version and is notified to certificants before it takes effect.

15.3 Transitional rule

Conduct is judged under the version of the Code in force at the time of the conduct. Where the current version is more favourable to the person, the current version applies.

15.4 Language

The English text is the authoritative version. Translations are provided for convenience; where a translation and the English text differ, the English text governs.

— Related

- [ETH-02 – The principles explained](#) — the reasoning behind each of the eight principles, and where each one bites
- [ETH-03 – Reporting numbers under pressure: a casebook](#) — the obligations in §5 worked through realistic, fictitious dilemmas
- [ETH-04 – Conflicts of interest in project controls](#) — the operative detail behind §12
- [ETH-05 – The ethical use of AI and data](#) — the operative detail behind §10
- [ETH-06 – Raising concerns: complaints, investigations, sanctions](#) — how §13 and §14 actually run
- [CER-07 – Results, scoring, appeals and complaints](#) — the candidate-facing view of the same routes

— Sources and standards

- PCI Code of Professional Conduct (predecessor instrument), [docs/downloads/code-of-professional-conduct.md](#), repository copy read August 2026. This Code carries forward its eight principles without change of substance. The predecessor was issued under a credential code that has since been retired; the current project-controls credential is **PCL-AI**.
 - PCI Candidate AI-Use Policy, [docs/downloads/candidate-ai-use-policy.md](#), repository copy read August 2026 — source of the examination position at §11.2.3 and the practice position at §10.
-

- PCI Candidate Handbook, <docs/downloads/candidate-handbook.md>, repository copy read August 2026 — source of the examination conduct rules at §11.2 and the appeals and complaints separation at §13.
- ISO/IEC 17024:2012, Conformity assessment — General requirements for bodies operating certification of persons. Referenced as a design principle for impartiality and fair process, described here in our own words. PCI is developed with reference to it and is **not accredited** by any accreditation body.

— Status and version

Founding-stage document · Version 1.0 · draft · Reviewed under PCI governance. PCI makes no claims of accreditation or recognition beyond what is true today.